

Fig. 5.2. Horizontal Filing

i. **Lever Arch Files:** It is a very popular type of horizontal file. It can be described as a strong card-board folder which contains strong metal arches which can be opened with the help of a lever. Records to be filed are punched with two holes with the help of the punching machine either at the top or on the left hand side of the forms, and are then files on the metal uprights, after the arch has been opened by the lever. The arch lever file facilitates alphabetical division which is done by inserting thick cards at suitable places. The great advantage of this file is that papers can be inserted or taken out with great ease without disturbing the order of other papers in the file. The file also offers the advantage of proper preservation of papers free from mutilation and dust, if the files are stored properly in the almirahs.



Fig. 5.3. Lever Arch

ii. **Flat Files:** The "files" (or covers) are made of cardboard or thick paper. A separate cover is allotted to each subject or customer, which contains all the relevant correspondence and documents in this file. The received letters and invoices posted and other relevant documents get filed in the chronological order where a letter or a document needs to be filed at more than one place, the necessary number of copies is made and filed in each relevant file. The flat file has metal hinges which are inserted into the holes punched by the punching machine.

The prepared files are stored in almirahs and placed on top of each other. They are also stored in drawers.



Fig. 5.4. Flat Files

Advantages of Horizontal Filing:

1. It is a simple method to operate.
2. It is a cheap method to install.
3. The papers are kept in order in which they have been filed.
4. Speedy reference can be made to papers without removing them.

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